This month in programming

Docker goes paid, AWS releases Swift and Kotlin SDKs, Oracle opens up JDK 17, Microsoft talks about extensibility and more news from the developer world this month.

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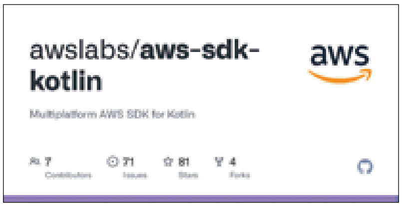
AWS announces alpha release SDKs for Swift and Kotlin

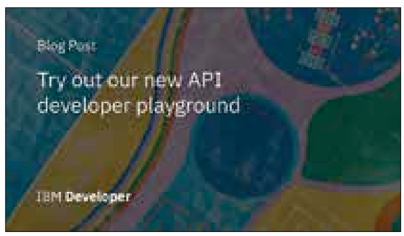
AWS users who are comfortable with language constructs native to AWS tools and wish to start with Kotlin or Swift can rejoice. AWS has announced two new SDKs, one each for Swift and Kotlin which will behave in a similar fashion to



the other SDKs that they have been using to develop on AWS. Both SDKs are currently in their alpha release. For Swift, AWS users had to rely on the community led Soto SDK and AWS Smoke SDK, whereas for Kotlin, folks could either refer to the Java SDK and make modifications wherever necessary. Detailed documentation for devs wanting to migrate from existing SDKs to the new AWS SDKs are not yet out. We will be seeing more of that once the two SDKs get closer to general release. Kotlin is 100% interoperable with Java, hence the migration for Kotlin users will be a breeze whereas for Swift users, it would be prudent to adopt a wait-and-watch approach. Both SDKs can be found on their respective GitHub repositories.

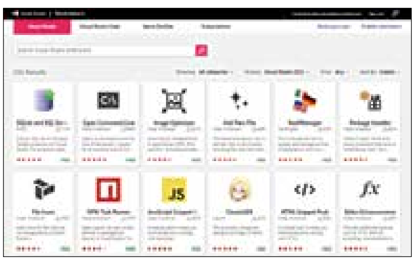
Microsoft talks extensibility for Visual Studio

Microsoft, in a new blog entry, revealed how the company was looking at the extensibility of Visual Studio to provide a more enriching development experience. The company has put out a new GitHub repository to be the hub for all the extensibility related updates that the company is working on. They're calling it the VSExtensibility Repo. The simplest of these updates revolves around the use of extensions or plugins. Visual Studio users



will be quite familiar with extensions such as VSVim, Productivity Power Tools, CodeRush, etc which are all now easily accessible from a simple hub and more will be added to the list. Another key feature is the expanded Language Server Protocol which help in enabling functionalities such as obtaining diagnostics information and project contexts while communicating with an active instance. Also introduced is a new out-of-proc extensibility model which allows Visual Studio to load

IBM introduces new API developer playground



After having introduced the IBM API Hub back in February this year, IBM has taken things a step further and launched the API developer playground. Developers can now discover new APIs, read the documentation and try out the different endpoints of the API in a secure and simple manner. The Developer Playground provides simple tutorials along with sample apps to demonstrate exactly how the API would function in a production environment. Once you've experimented enough with a code sample, you can even save it to your code repo and get right into implementing it in your projects. IBM already has several useful APIs for developers to try out. These include the Data Quality for AI API by IBM, HERE Public Transit API by HERE Technologies, etc., and more.